

SOC Team Internals:-

SOC L1 Alert Triage:- $\rightarrow$ (Quickly Sorting, analyzing, and prioritizing incoming security alerts)

Learn more About SOC Alerts and Build a systematic approach to efficiently triaging team).

Task 1:- Introduction

An alert is core concept of any SOC team, and knowing how to handle it properly ultimately decides whether a security breach is detected and prevented or missed and devastating.

This is an entry level but essential room for SOC L1 analysts to understand the concept of lifecycle of alerts, from event generation to correct resolution.

Learning objectives :-

- * Familiarise with concept of SOC alert
- * Explore alert fields, statuses and classification
- * Learn how to perform alert triage as an L1 analyst
- * Practice with real alerts and SOC workflows
- * Prepare for SOC simulator and SAL1 certification

Prerequisites:-

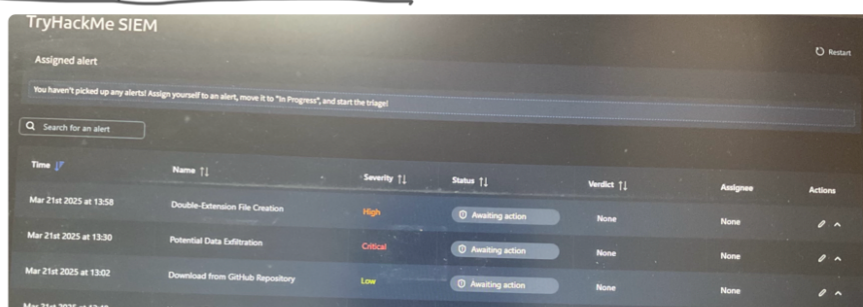
- * Understand common attacks on network, windows and linux
- * Know SOC roles and duties, especially of L1 analysts.

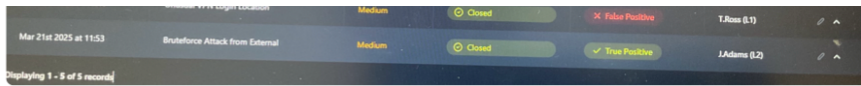
SOC Dashboard:-

- * You were granted access to SOC Dashboard in TryHackMe SIEM, and you will need it to complete most of the tasks. Open the attached website in separate window, familiarise yourself with it and move on to next task!

Note:- (SIEM means Security Information and Event Management System that is used to Aggregate Security Information in form of logs, alerts, artifacts and events into a centralized platform that would allow security analysts to perform near real time analysis during security monitoring).

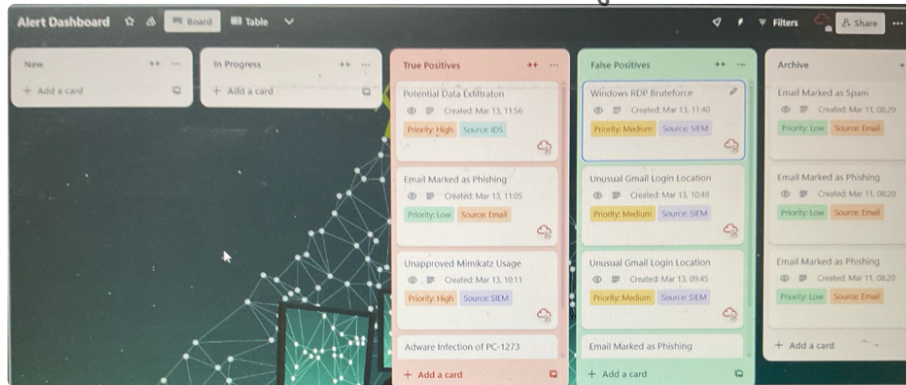
Access	Granted
URL	SOC dashboard





Task 2 :- Events and Alerts

Imagine yourself as SOC intern, looking at monitor of your mentor, a SOC L1 or L2 Analyst, and seeing hundreds of alerts appear, moving between statuses and eventually disappearing from some dashboard or console. You noticed lots of alerts named "Email marked as phishing", a few "Unusual Gmail login location", and one scary "Unapproved Mimikatz usage" inside a red column. What are these alerts, how are they formed, and what should we do with them? Let's find out!



From Events to Alerts :-

First, an Event must occur, like user login, process launch or file download. Then, the System like your OS, firewall or cloud provider must log the event. After that all system logs must be shipped to Security solution like SIEM or EDR. The SOC team can receive millions of logs per day from thousands of different systems, where most of the events are expected, but some require attention. Alert a notification generated by Security Solution when specific event or sequence of events occurs, is what saves SOC analysts from manual log review by highlighting only suspicious, anomalous events. With alerts, analyst triage just dozen of alerts per day instead of millions of raw logs.

Alert management platform :-

Solution	Examples	Description
SIEM System	Splunk ES, Elastic	SIEM have solid alert management capabilities and are perfect choice for most SOC team
EDR or NDR	CrowdStrike, MS Defender	While EDR and NDR provide their own alert dashboards, its preferred to use SIEM or SOAR
SOAR System	Splunk SOAR, Cortex SOAR	Bigger SOC teams can use SOAR to aggregate and centralise alerts from multiple solutions
ITSM team	Jira, The Hive	Some teams may have a custom ticket management (ITSM) rather than a dedicated solution

L1 Role in Alert Triage :-

SOC L1 analysts are first line of defense, and they are the ones who work with alerts the most.

Depending on various feeds, L1 analysts may receive ~~good~~ to hundred alerts a day, every one of which can reveal a cyber attack. Still everyone in SOC team is somehow involved in alert triage.

* SOC L1 Analysts :- Review the alerts, distinguish bad from good, and notify L2 analysts in case of real threat.

* SOC L2 Analysts :- Review the alerts escalated by L1 Analysts and perform deeper analysis and remediation.

* SOC Engineers :- Ensure the alerts contains enough information required for efficient alert triage.

* SOC Manager :- Track speed and quality of alert triage to ensure that real attacks won't be missed.